Besties

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/64919008.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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F/F

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Bow & Glimmer (She-Ra)

Characters:
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by Rabenkater

Summary

"So, you know Spinny and T ossa, they're best friends like us," Adora refers to two senior girls, just a year or so older than her and Catra.
"Y eah Adora, Iknow them." Catra still hasn't looked up, and so Adora barrels ahead.
"Y esterday Isaw them kissing under the bleachers. And, uh, since they're best friends and we are best friends I.. wanted to know if that's something that you would want to do."

~
Found this in my drafts, thought someone might enjoy :)

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

~

High School. Junior Year.

~

Adora is nervous, but she's not beating herself up about it. She has a right to be nervous, even if it's laughable. Catra is her best friend. It's the pinnacle of her dilemma and also the solution. Best friends are there for each other, like, always. They listen, they help, they forgive and... apparently they do other things, too.

Catra is Adora's best friend. The bestest of best friends. They both swore up and down that they're the absolutely bestest best friends there is. Which leads to the dilemma Adora is currently facing. Because there better be no other couple of best friends be better best friends than her and Catra. (Say that three times fast!)

She sits down next to Catra, her hands firmly lodged under her thighs.

Catra flicks her right ear towards her but doesn't look up from where she's watching a video on her phone.

Adora blows out a breath and breaks the silence.

"So, you know Spinny and Tossa, they're best friends like us," Adora refers to two senior girls, just a year or so older than her and Catra.

"Yeah Adora, I know them." Catra still hasn't looked up, and so Adora barrels ahead.

"Yesterday I saw them kissing under the bleachers. And, uh, since they're best friends and we are best friends I... wanted to know if that's something that you would want to do. With me. Your best friend. Or not, if that's weird?"

She's a little breathless now because of her non stop rambling, and also because this is at least a little weird, right? In her periphery she can see that Catra has finally looked up, but Adora is not going to turn her head and look over to see how her best friend is probably glaring at her right now, searching for the right words to chew Adora out because of this ludicrous idea. Adora just waits, staring at the pavement beneath her slightly scuffed tennis shoes.

After a few seconds the video on Catra's phone stops blaring and they're sitting in silence. That is, until this time Catra breaks it.

"Because best friends... kiss?" she asks slowly, as if she wasn't certain what Adora had implied.
"I mean, Spinny and Tossa do, and they're -"
"Best friends, yeah, you mentioned. So... do you want to kiss me?" Adora finally looks up, her eyes flickering to Catra's lips just for a second. Catra's ears are perked, her eyes huge and her pupils blown. This is not her 'are you fucking kidding me' face, and neither is it her 'watch what you're saying' face but rather her 'let's see where this is going' face, which is why Adora gathers her courage to admit what has been on her mind since she saw Spinny and Tossa under those bleachers: "Yes."
The kiss comes faster than she thought—really, she hadn't thought about who would initiate and when it would happen that much, but when Catra all but tackles her, Adora is not complaining. There is nothing to complain about at all. Catra's lips are just so soft and warm and the pressure and the little puff of air from Catra's nose only make Adora feel whole. This is their friendship personified.
After an arguably too short amount of time Catra leans back with a little gasp. Air, yes. Good idea. Adora's breath is ridiculously labored, even if kissing doesn't hold a candle to a good cardio workout.
"Okay. I get why they're doing it all the time," Adora breathes, as soon as she has gulped down enough air to work her vocal cords again. Catra is staring at her in what Adora estimates is a mirror image of her own dazed face.
"Uh?"
Adora frowns. Catra does know who Adora is talking about, she is sure of it. Maybe she's just distracted. Her eyes seem to be glued to Adora's lips. As entertaining as the thought of maybe kissing her best friend again sometime soon is, Adora has to voice her thoughts, lest they would go haywire inside her brain.
"Spinny and Tossa-"
"Can you just stop yapping about Spinny and Tossa for a minute and kiss me again?" is how Catra cuts her off. "I think you have to try it a few more times before it gets really good."
Oh. That was something Adora hadn't thought about until it now consumes every anxious brain cell at her disposal.
"I.. thought it was good, already?" she meekly says, biting her lower

lip that is still tingling from Catra's warmth.
Catra rolls her eyes, pouting. "Fine, then don't," she grouches, turning her head and watching Adora from the corner of her eyes.
"No, no! I mean, practice makes perfect, and what kind of a best friend would I be if I wouldn't make sure that it's good for you, too," Adora hastily assures her best friend. She has to make a battle plan later on, but if one has to train kissing to get better at it, she's definitely going to do that.
"It was good for me, you worrywart... I just thought it could get... better, with experience, you know ."
"Yeah, yeah, exactly! I was thinking the same thing."
Catra chuckles, now again turned back so that she can face Adora. Her head is slightly cocked, and a smirk is growing on her lips. Adora would freely admit that she's staring, but she doesn't have to. Catra just chuckles again and leans in and this time Adora leans in too, scooting closer to maybe get a better angle. A squeak emits from Catra's throat, caught by Adora's lips, and clawed hands grab Adora's lapels for balance. She is an inch or two taller than Catra, even when they're sitting, Adora remembers, and so she supports her best friend with her hands on Catra's hips. Getting pushed off of the bench would surely cut this training exercise in kissing short, and Adora so does not want that.

~

Adora doesn't even remember what Glimmer was talking about. It pales in light of the last words that left her friends mouth. Words that had started a resounding alarm inside Adora's head: "- and that's why you're my best friend, Adora," Glimmer had said, and now Adora is reeling in how to navigate this wreck of a relationship. She's also a little bit offended. Everyone should know Catra's her best friend, so why would Glimmer say something like that?
"We're not best friends," Adora spits out with a healthy dose of panic and shock.
Glimmer stares at her, looking a little hurt.
Adora is panicking—what if someone overheard, what if Catra heard?! She doesn't want Catra to think there's some other best

friend that Adora is kissing!
"Catra is my best friend!"
"Uh, yeah? You can have more than one best friend," is what Bow suggests. He watches Adora closely. "Me and Glimm are best friends, too."
Adora vehemently shakes her head. She has to make this crystal clear to her two rather new friends. "Catra. Catra is my best friend, period. We-," she gesticulates hastily between the three of them, "-can be friends, but not best friends. That is Catra to me."
She sure as hell isn't going to kiss either of them!
"I mean, fine, I guess." Glimmer looks a bit glum but bounces back rather quickly when Bow announces: "Hey, we could be the best friend squad! Like two couples of best friends forming a friend group."
Adora blinks, her panic residing.
"Nah, it should be the Glimmer Group!" Glimmer laughingly suggests, and Adora chuckles.
"Best friend squad? Yeah, that would work. Just let me talk Catra into it, don't mention it yourself. She'll probably claw you. I'm her best friend, after all."

~

Adora's been pacing for at least five minutes and she's pretty sure her boots are going to wear a path into the girl's bathroom's tile. Not that Catra seems to care. Her best friend is leaned up against one of the three out of five not yet destroyed sinks, arms crossed, and looking annoyingly chill like she didn't just have her entire life almost ruined fifteen minutes ago.
"I just-I didn't knew what to say," Adora bursts out, and it echoes in the bathroom. "She said I was her best friend, Catra. And then Bow said we could all be best friends together. And-what was I supposed to say to that?"
Catra raises an eyebrow, unimpressed. "Thanks?"
"That's not funny!" Adora groans and runs a hand through her hair, positively destroying her hair poof. "Dang, she'll have to fix that later."
"I don't want to kiss either of them!" she whines, turning around

again and lightly kicking against one of the open stall-doors.
Catra still isn't getting it, apparently, because now she's just trying to cough up a hairball, if Adora is placing that sound right. She's not turning around right now, because she already did witness that once, and she doesn't plan on watching anything gross in the near future. So she just rants on, keeping her back turned as to give Catra some privacy. "I don't understand it. I mean, Bow and Glimmer are not even like, kissing, I didn't even know they were best friends!"
"Well," Catra's voice is a bit rough, but that's to be expected after her disgorging, "maybe they're not best friends like we are," she says slowly, and when Adora spins around in confusion, she can see Catra's tail flicking in that 'I'm irritated'-way. "I mean, there are… different levels of being best friends," Catra mumbles, "and we, uh, wouldn't want them to be jealous of the fact that we're obviously better best friends than them, right?"
"Uh," Adora makes unintelligently, not getting the point of Catra's explanation.
"Best we keep kisses to us, I mean, like, in private."
"Oh. Yeah, okay." Adora blinks owlishly. That makes sense. Glimmer is awfully competitive and would probably see it as a challenge or such. And with her and Catra not having the best track record so far that would result in a bad time for everyone. "So, no public kisses," she meekly clarifies.
"Mhmhm."
Damn, she really doesn't want to stop kissing Catra at all, if possible. Maybe... "But... when it's just the two of us, it's okay?" Adora asks sheepishly, coughing lightly into her fist in an attempt to hide her fluster.
"Like right now?" Catra smirks, her voice lilting in that cute way that makes Adora's heart clench at times. "Yes, Adora. Right now is perfect."
"Uh- would you mind brushing you teeth? You just coughed up a hairball, and-"
"What are you talking about, moron?" Catra somehow pairs her snark with a giggle and just pulls Adora in by her lapels.
Every thought about hairballs, Glimmer, or Bow flies straight out of

Adora's head when her lips meet Catra's, and that distinct Catra-taste floods her mind.

~

Retrospectively, Adora would never understand how she could have been so oblivious for almost five years. But, as her friends would try to cheer her up much later, no one even realized that a lone person could be so fucking dumb and not already have it realized in the sixteen years before that.

Thanks a lot.

~

~

College. Senior Year.

~

In a rare coincidence, Adora's tuesday-seminar has been canceled and she is able to meet up with some of her friends for an evening hangout. Glimmer, Bow and Mermista met up with her just outside of the cute on-campus-café with the rainbow colored parasols. They sit down on a bench under one of the parasols, drinking their coffees and teas and in Bow's case a large chocolate milkshake.
"Spinnerella invited us to her wedding," Mermista says conversationally, referring to her and her currently absent boyfriend Sea Hawk, and Adora looks up while her friend languidly concludes: "yours is probably still in the mail."
"It's about time!" Glimmer cheers, and Bow just coos.
Racking her brain if Spinnerella had ever mentioned a girlfriend and not finding anything, Adora simply asks: "Oh? Who's she marrying?"
All three of her friends look at her as if she had sprouted another head just now.
"What?"
"Netossa, of course," Mermista scoffs with an eye roll. "Did you live under a rock for the last, dunno, six years?"
"Oh," Adora says and furrows her brows. Neither Mermista nor

Glimmer pay her antics any more thought but rather start to talk about the different styles of wedding dresses, so when Adora is finally able to articulate her puzzlement, she addresses Bow. "I thought they were best friends."
Bow blinks at her owlishly, and much to her annoyance Mermista and Glimmer heard her, which they show through laughing out loudly.
"Like you and Catra are best friends?" Glimmer teases with a shit-eating-grin, wiggling her eyebrows. Mermista snorts, hiding her grin behind her mug.
Adora blinks at Glimmer a few times, her gaze flickering towards Mermista, then Bow, all of whom now scrutinize her lack of reaction. Great, now she's feeling uncomfortable. She and her anxiety are the focus of all three of her friends and Adora feels as if she walked into an exam she hasn't studied for.
"Yeah?" she says slowly, her heart beating a bit too loudly in her own ears. Why does that sound like it's the wrong answer?
"Adora, as much as we all like you... You're not slick at all," Bow explains, "I think every single person in our friend group walked in on you and Catra kissing some time or the other."
"Okay?"
The three of them exchange looks Adora isn't able to decipher.
"You're... not denying it?"
"Why would I?"
"Uh, we don't know! Why were you hiding it, then?" Glimmer exclaims exasperatedly.
"We did not wanted to make anyone jealous of us being better friends than you guys?"
Glimmer suddenly stands up, pushing her mug into Bow's hands and climbs on Adora's lap, forcefully gripping her head and pushing it backwards to look her in the eyes.
"Ow, Glimm, wha-," she shrieks, panicky trying to not spill her hot tea onto her friend.
"Are you high? Drunk?"
"What are you talking about! And just-," she squabbles at Glimmers fingers with her one free hand and almost pushes her off entirely.
"That hurt!"

"Adora," Bow says slowly , while Mermista stares at her, mouth slightly agape, "What do you mean by ... kissing makes you better friends," he summarizes.
"Are you nuts? When you kiss your best friend, you're obviously better best friends than normal best friends."
"What are you, twelve?" Mermista bluntly says.
"Are you telling me," Glimmer now practically screeches, "that Catra ~~is~~ our Catra is playing along this best-friends-do-smooch' with you? Never , ever does she not know that that's not part of being a best friend!"
That somehow sounded like an attack on her best friend(ship), so Adora indignantly shouts out: "Hey!" but before she can add to that, Mermista interrupts her.
"Girl, when you're kissing your bestie, you're dating. Like girlfriends dating. What did you think the difference between that and being besties was?"
"Catra and I are not dating-"
"Does she know that?" Mermista quips, and suddenly the severity of the situation sinks in. Adora feels frozen inside. Fuck. What if Catra thinks they're dating? Her lungs are bound with iron chains, her heart struggles to keep beating, her fingers flex uselessly , what if Catra doesn't want-
"Okay , breathe, Adora! Focus on three things you can see right now-"
She is gasping for air, her vision focused on a pinprick of light. "Mug. Bench. Glimmer," she wheezes out, swallowing a large gulp of air and slowly releasing it between each word. The pinprick grows bigger again, until all three things fit together in her field of vision. Glimmer is kneeling in front of the bench, Adora's mug in her hands.
"Wow, no wonder Catra never talked to her about it," she hears Mermista murmur towards Bow while Glimmer walks her through the rest of her sudden panic attack.
"You're Adora," Glimmer says, her hand patting Adora's right knee. "And you're going to make a plan. You want our help?"
Adora shrugs once, trusting Glimmer to set her mind up into the right mindset.
"Okay , first, uh... first is 'what do I know'," she says, trying to mimic

Adora's typical strategy when confronted with a problem.
"Catra is my best friend."
"... and you're kissing for ... how long exactly?"
Adora closes her eyes for a second. "Glimm, thanks for helping, but I think I have to go now," she says contrary to her want for help, standing up on shaky legs.
"What? Where are you going?"
"I tell you."
"Go get her," Mermista smirks, and Adora feels herself blush. She's already half way to the bus station when Bow catches up to her.
"You forgot your backpack," he wheezes, one hand on her shoulder, with the other he holds out said backpack.
"Thanks, I-"
"Look, Adora, I know you're rational and a planner most of the time, but right now you might not be in the right mindset to- let me just say one thing you should think about before you confront Catra: What kind of relationship do you want with her? Because I'm pretty sure Catra is head over heals for you."
Adora swallows thickly.
Catra is cunning, beautifully so. She is intelligent, a detailed planner just like Adora. She's keen and a little bit mean but she would never hurt or exploit someone maliciously beyond reasonably getting what she wants.
And isn't that the indicator Adora is looking for?
Catra would have known. From the very beginning Catra would have known that Spinnerella and Netossa hat been dating. That what Adora had seen wasn't because the two older girls were best friends, but because they were girlfriends. Catra had fed Adora's misconception to gain what she, Catra, wanted. To kiss her best friend. Over and over again. And she had known that their shared friends would have labeled that as dating. Why did she never indicate that they should talk about this?
Option one: Catra does want to kiss Adora, does want to be her best friend, but doesn't want to date Adora.
Option two: Catra is scared that Adora wants to kiss Catra, wants to be her best friend, but does not want to date Catra.
There is just the thing: They're hanging out pretty much every day.

They plan on living together once they've finished college, have already looked at a few apartment listings together. They go out for dinner or brunch, watch a movie, study together despite their not-at-all-related fields, solve an escape room or do karaoke in a hybrid-friendly bar on a near daily basis.
What else is dating?

Option two it is.

~

Catra opens the door of her much too small but scholarship-inclusive single dorm room, a little surprised to see Adora. "Hey, didn't know you were coming, what's up?"
Adora stares at her, stepping inside and Catra blinks up at her best friend, confused. Adora captures Catra's head in her hands and steps closer still. She doesn't speak, and then she can't because her lips are suddenly pressed insistently against Catra's. An almost silent purr erupts from Catra's throat, and it then roars to life when Adora deepens the kiss, stumbling Catra's back against the now closed door. Catra sneaks her arms around Adora's shoulders. Her mind is reeling, it's as if choirs of angels are sitting right next to them, singing – it's that kind of mindblowingly good kiss. Catra keens and presses herself against all of Adora's eagerness. It takes a minute or so, but when her brain catches up, Catra is recognizing that faint smell that is ever so slowly growing stronger. Adora is turned on. Adora is finally making a move, spurned by lust, by ardent desire and it is all Catra has ever dreamed of. She opens her lips to the insistent kiss and Adora takes the invitation, deepens the kiss even more, cautiously exploring her mouth. Catra is in heaven. It is finally going to happen. After five fucking years of being besties.
Adora wants her, even if it is just a fleeting lust thing – it won't matter.
Because right now Adora wants Catra, just like Catra wants Adora all the time. Even if it's just this once, Catra couldn't care less. She'll take it. Take it and never let go. This is as real as it gets and Catra shoves the already melancholic thoughts of 'after' down deeply into the dark of her mind. Adora isn't drunk or high or anything, she

knows what she's doing, who she's with and nothing is more important right now than her lips, her tongue, her hands.
Adora grabs her by the hips, pulls her up without breaking the kiss, and presses Catra with her body against the door. Catra moans and wraps her legs around Adora's middle, her hands in Adora's hair , the fucking ponytail and hair poof gone for who knows how long already. Adora has her pinned, cadged, but Catra couldn't care less that this is normally a feeling that she would fight tooth and claw to get out of. There's so many other feelings involved that are turning this into the outright best time of her life.
Slowly, Adora shifts their deep kiss into her tracing Catra's lips, kissing the edge of her mouth, kissing her jaw , moving to her throat. Catra groans, her head pressing against the door, desperately trying to get any body part Adora is kissing even closer to her lips. Adora bites her neck, licks the short fur on it, kisses it, and Catra is whimpering. She is fully surrounded by Adora, and in the best possible way. More. She wants so much more, despite this being so much more already. Catra can feel the hot breath against her neck when Adora suddenly speaks, a whisper almost: "Are we dating?"
It is not a cold feeling, but the shock of words make her feel as if she's been doused with water . Catra blinks a few times against Adora kissing her way further down towards her clavicle. She's imagining things, surely. Her wildest dreams go like this, but the reality is that Adora is so obliviously best-friend-zoning her all the time that it's not even funny anymore (it never was).
Catra isn't sure how long she's trying to stitch her thoughts back together, but it must be long enough for Adora to grow impatient. She stops, kissing the mark on Catra's neck softly and then admiring her handiwork, repeating rather breathlessly: "Are we dating, Catra?"
Adora still hasn't looked up again, her head buried in Catra's neck. Catra now understands. She understands just how understanding Adora is of her. Adora is deliberately giving her the space to freak out a little bit without anyone, not even herself, being able to see Catra's face, but without giving her the chance to bolt like there's a pack of rabid dogs after her either. She is showing Catra what she wants the answer to be, because if she wouldn't want it to be a 'yes', her greeting and everything that had followed would have transpired

rather differently. Catra's heart is bursting at its seams.
Adora kisses the mark again, her thumbs slowly rubbing Catra's hips to anchor her but at the same time it makes her want to drag Adora to the bedroom. She is not the most 'giving-you-a-straight-answer' kind of person (primarily because she's not straight) and her heart is hammering with the thought of baring her utmost inner self to the world that is Adora.
Catra grabs Adora by the hair, bending her head back, so that she can see her determined, open, anxious face. "Do you want to?" she whispers, unsure and hopeful, just so fucking hopeful, because she can't answer without knowing for sure that's what Adora wants.
Adora smiles sweetly as she declares in a hushed tone: "Yes."
Catra almost sobs in relief, choking on words to big for her and decides the best course of action is to kiss Adora again.

~

Adora: We're dating now. Not a word about yesterday. To no one, not even Catra. You are allowed to maybe use it as a funny story when we're getting married.

Glimmer: Finally!

Glimmer: Anyone noticed how she wrote *when* and not *if*? ;)

Mermista: Anyone notice she wrote this in the early morning hours? That's what I call stamina ;)

Adora: Shut up!

Adora removed Glimmer and Mermista from the group

Bow: Told you :)

Adora: ...It won't allow me to remove you, because you're the last

person in this chat, and then it will cease to exist.

Adora left the group

Bow :(

~

A few years down the road, Glimmer smirks evilly. "... and that's why we're here today," she says and raises her glass of champagne. "To two disaster lesbians U-hauling hard."
Laughter and cheers fill the restaurant floor as the guest applaud Glimmer's toast as maid of honor.
"Also we finally get to know the other side of the story," Netossa chips in from her place between Scorpia and her wife, Spinerella. "So, Catra, did you know that kissing wasn't just for best friends?" she mockingly asks.
Catra scoffs with a smile on her lips. She glances over to Adora next to her, her newly wedded wife blushing profusely. "Of course I knew! But when your biggest fucking crush since you're eight years old comes to you, all like 'We're best friends, and Tossa and Spinny are best friends and I saw them kissing, maybe we should start kissing, too.'," you bet your sweet ass I was going to say 'Fuck yeah, count me in!'

End Notes

Catra knew. Like, she was freaking out for a while if this was Adora's way of asking her out and she was ecstatic, but then she realized she's in love with a moron.

Also, and I can not stress this enough: Adora canonically did not know what an aunt is and refused to ask, banking on anyone to explain it. She absolutely did not know .

Glimmer was the first to walk in on them. It was a sleepover at her place and she had an argument with her mom and when she came back she did a double take before backtracking and then deliberately stomping in the corridor.
Mermista almost blew Catra's cover when she saw them, but was distracted by Sea Hawk setting a tablecloth on fire.
Everyone just thought Catra was really private about it and coerced Adora into secrecy. Also they made severeal insinuations over the years, all of which flew directly over Adora's head.

The words "best friends" make up about roughly 2.5% of this fanfic (108 out of 4362 words per my document)

I love the "this is their story and now we're at their wedding" trope, even though I might never have written one out until now... I think it's a long time since I posted...

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!